

background guide

AD-HOC COMMITTEE OF THE SECRETARY GENERAL

DAY 2 did you see this coming?



Letter from the Dias

Hi everyone!

This definitely is a change of events, isn't it?

Welcome to Day 2 of the Ad-Hoc of the Secretary-General.

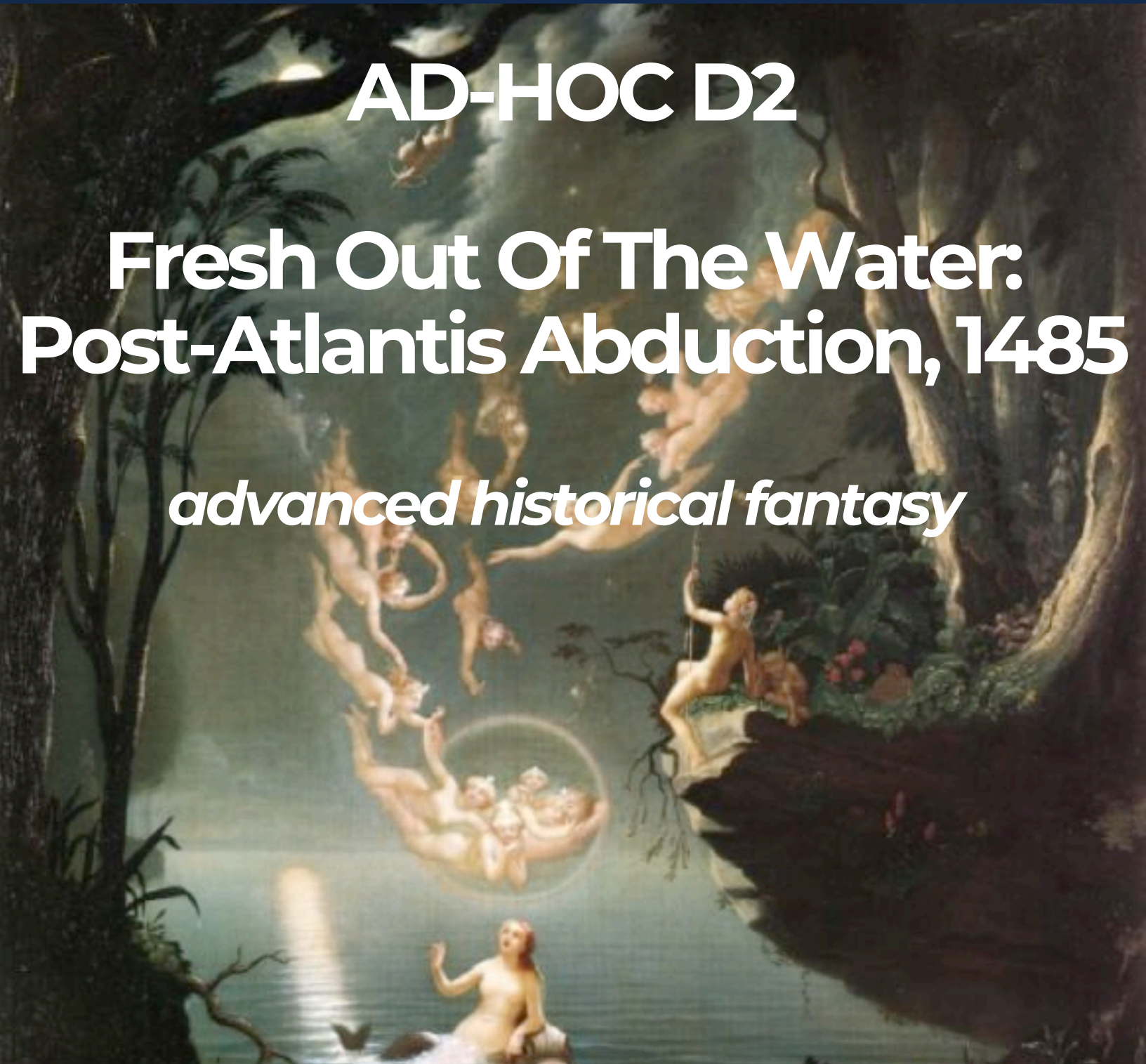
The Dias

background guide

AD-HOC D2

Fresh Out Of The Water: Post-Atlantis Abduction, 1485

advanced historical fantasy





Committee Description

This committee will resume as an advanced nontraditional **fantasy historical** committee.

For the purposes of quickly understanding this rather nuanced historical topic within this brief reading period, the content presented in the 'background' section of this guide is very streamlined. There is no additional research necessary.

Delegates should prioritize detailed, meaningful arcs in their backroom development; the preparatory/reading period should be fully utilized to understand not only details pertinent to the committee but skills necessary to succeed in crisis committees (see <https://muni.illinoismun.org/crisis> and *highly recommended* come to our Crisis Prep session tomorrow morning!)



Synopsis

Hear ye, Hear ye;
The year is now 1485.

15 years have passed since the English Royal Court has disappeared into the great waves of the Atlantic Ocean. Yet, 15 years on the day, the Court reappeared from the ocean enlightened with the ways of Atlantis. However, the land that welcomed them back is now much changed and almost foreign from what they left.

In your disappearance, France and Burgundy have entered into an alliance and merged their territory. This new extra-large territory has also encroached upon England, invading England and taking over a fourth of the land. Thankfully, remaining English forces were able to stop efforts to restore Edward IV to the throne. A large party was thrown regardless by the Franco-Burgundians for their capture of the land, and during the merriment a new man slipped onto the throne.

Instead of an Island ruled by Lancaster, York, or Tudor, they find a somewhat smelly man: Perkin Warbeck. This man claims to be one of the lost brothers from the Prince in the Tower incident. Having declared his claim in Burgundy's court, he won critical backing, and thus, for these last 15 years the British Isles have been under the control of this Burgundian-supported king. However, the nobles have not taken kindly to this rule, and they have been demanding for Parliament to gain back control.

Regardless, no formal push has been made to eject Perkin Warbeck, as his claim seems founded. Innocent until proven guilty indeed.

As for the peasantry, not much has changed in the ways of their typical life. Many still face starvation, toil, and repression as Perkin Warbeck has elected to divert investments to his Burgundian supporters. This was made evermore evident when an outbreak of Sweats swept through the isles rampaging the populace. The hapless Perkin Warbeck was unable to fight back this pestilence as he found supporting a Burgundian war more important.



Synopsis (cont.)

While Perkin Warbeck has been allowed to pursue Burgundian objectives, Parliament in the meantime has grown in influence. This Parliament is largely composed of Lancastrians who fell out of favor with the royal lines and sought power elsewhere. This sudden change in influence was only possible with the growing strength of the nobility as they filled in the void that Perkin Warbeck's rule had created. The growing noble class has used the momentum to tighten their control over their lands allowing many to disregard direct commands from King Warbeck. Nonetheless, the increased influence has not been felt within the king's court. Parliament has tried to exert influence through the power of the purse, however, the King has been able to ignore such brothers by dipping into the Burgundian treasury.

The New House of York was at first apprehensive about this Perkin Warbeck claim of "Richard of Shrewsbury," yet once the Burgundian money came flowing in, any and all complaints ceased. Thus, the house of York has found itself entrenched in the orbit around Perkin Warbeck. No matter how radical the claim the King makes, the New Yorks seem to follow. With the return of the remaining Yorkist from Atlantis, the family's loyalties seem to be split between old and new.

The British Isles were not the only place with much change—so was the continent. What once was a fractured western Europe has now been dominated by the French-Burgundian Union. With opposition from Hispaniola (busy with the reconquista), Holy Roman Empire (sieging Vienna), and the Italian states (fractured). The balance of power has shifted allowing for the French-Burgundian Union, alongside their British puppet, to run amuck. Their rule across the content is unopposed, however, a unified foe may be able to muster the strength to take them down.

As it stands, here are your current alignments:

Character List

Parliament:

Henry IV

While Henry was waiting to get his throne back, a new threat had come for him in the name of Perkin Warbeck. His wife has now divorced him and he has no money left in his pockets, though he now has a great power in Parliament with his fellow fallen Lancastrians. After being kicked out of England royalty, he was welcomed in the Welsh noble class. He is also considered the French heir to the throne and is now thinking about taking back his throne in France.

Richard Neville, Earl of Warwick

After being put into Parliament, Warwick now possesses more power and is also an ally in the Welsh nobility who provide him with any backing he needs. He has married off his son to the daughter of a wealthy noble family. Due to the public disfavoring of the current King Warbeck, the Earl of Warwick has found strong support both with the general English public and the Parliament. Warwick possesses a lot of public power now.

John de Vere, Earl of Oxford

This Earl now possesses power as a member of Parliament and an ally of the Welsh! But he has not forgotten the injustice that Edward IV committed against his father and elder brother—both of them were executed!! He will be seeking revenge against him with all his new power!

Jasper Tudor of Wales

Fresh out of the water, Jasper Tudor has returned to a political landscape far more fractured than the one he left behind. Once a steadfast Lancastrian loyalist, he now finds himself in a position of unexpected leverage. While Parliament offers him a platform to reassert Lancastrian influence, Jasper's long-term priorities may lie elsewhere, namely in securing the future of his nephew, Henry Tudor. Will he reinvent this dynasty in the Tudor name.

Character List

New House of York (New Yorks):

Edward IV

Edward has returned to a political landscape beyond his recognition. Though still bearing the legacy of a former king, his authority has been eroded by time, exile, and the rise of Perkin Warbeck's Burgundian-backed regime. The New House of York has thus far aligned itself with Warbeck, drawn in by wealth and stability, leaving Edward to question where true loyalty lies. Now he must decide whether or not to reclaim his throne through force or navigate the emerging power of Parliament.

John Neville, Marquess of Montagu

In the fifteen years under the sea, Montagu has grown in his leadership skills and is confident that there is now no worthy contemporary to him in military strength and know-how. When he returns to land, he is welcomed by legions of soldiers that grew in his absence and have sworn loyalty to his family line.

Richard, Duke of Gloucester

The duke has returned from the undersea to find that his family has invested their wealth into the Medici banking dynasty. His assets have grown significantly and he is excited to have come back from Atlantis to find himself the kingpin of a rapidly growing textile enterprise.

William Herbert, Earl of Pembroke

In William's absence, his two sons have explored the world and found powerful seats in the key Holy Roman Empire. As his sons have recently married into the families of Bohemian royals, he is now the CIO of their Bohemian gold mining operations. In fact, he's been so successful that his face now prominently features on the common shilling.



Character List

Foreign Powers

Margaret of Anjou

While Margaret was away in Atlantis, her parents didn't sit around and wait for the return of their precious daughter. René of Anjou (Margaret's father) had enriched his position in the French court by leveraging his formal rule of Naples. To reward René of Anjou's loyalty, the French court awarded him the Duchy of Normandy on the condition that Margaret of Anjou would be the only one to inherit the land. On their first day back on land, Margaret annulled her marriage to Henry VI, and left for Normandy. But she didn't go alone...

Edward Westminster, Prince of Wales

Eddy has been the portrait of a good son until now. Having left England with his mother, he now holds claims both on Normandy and the English crown. Many in England still remember his charming personality and his courage. Charm is still not enough to win a crown, though- where good looks fail, one needs supplies, strategy, and bravery.

Louis XI

Having left France for 15 years, not too much has changed within court life. In his absence, Charles VIII has reigned France with a fair and just rule. Yet, the Burgundian French-Burgundian Union power has shifted towards the Burgundian nobles. With the return of Louis XI, Charles VIII regency comes to a close as many wonder how Louis XI will restore French power. Louis also comes back to a welcome surprise- a heir for the crown!

Charles the Bold

Shortly before the big plunge underwater, Charles was the victim of a poisoning. Time runs slowly in Atlantis, however, and he was very ill for seven long years. Yet, he has risen out of the depths to find that his line has blossomed in the new world order. The Burgundian royal court was more than happy to accept Charles the Bold back. The dominant partner in the Franco-Burgundian union is Burgundy, yet the French nobles still hold major sway. To ensure a secure realm, the goals of Burgundy must be met while the French nobles placated.



Closing Statement

We cannot wait to resume committee and see how you all navigate this theme!

All of you are currently equipped with the resources and materials that you gathered in your backroom notes, and as a plus you now have new portfolio resources as a result of this new background guide.

In this new three-way world, what group will come out on top? It'd be wise to stick with your bloc, but be careful who you trust.

Best of luck to all of you!

Nafisa Khan, Crisis Director
Justin Dyser, Chair
Divij Garg, Secretary-General